

"THE DARK OF DORGNAK'TOR"

Once the group returns to Windhollow and confers with Lord Pelengrast, they will find out that the townsfolk of Windhollow have been under attack from more than a few simple humanoids. While arriving at Windhollow, the companions should come under attack from a medium sized group of humanoids (orc or gnoll patrol) that includes at least one shaman. Hopefully the group has no problems dealing with the evil humanoid patrol and enters the town of Windhollow safely. Once they speak to Lord Pelengrast, they will probably determine that their most direct course of action will be to travel during the day, back up to the hidden valley and then wait for an opportune moment to re-enter the caverns.

There is a small percentage chance that the group will run into a roving patrol of humanoids while travelling to the mines. However, if the group follows the old mine road, then they will be ambushed by a large group of humanoids(30-40 individuals with three spellcasters), the ambush force size should be doubled if they are caught unawares at night. Hopefully they take an alternative route and arrive at the caverns undetected. If the group is patient, they will see a war party leave the caverns and leave the entrance to the mine practically unguarded.

If the group is able to sneak into the caverns, fairly undetected, they will only have to deal with a group of 10 orcs at the gates to Dorgnak'tor and the gate overseer, a ogre magi with five ogre bodyguards. Once the group deals with these humanoids, they can pass through the ancient doorway that leads to Dorgnak'tor. If by chance the group does not enter the ruins without being detected, than a returning patrol will be aware of their presence and be led by "Igrik'ilthul", a mind flayer/sorcerer of 10th level. Igrik'ilthul has been given charge of the entrance to the ruined dwarven city and responsibility of destroying the town of Windhollow. If the group manages to kill or capture him(very unlikely) than the attacks on Windhollow will cease and most of the mind controlled humanoid leaders will disperse. Igrik'ilthul does not report to his master every day, so the group might actually have two or three day's before it's discovered that someone has penetrated the mines.

Once within the ruins of Dorgnak'tor, the group will see signs that the ancient dwarven city was looted long ago. It is now home to over 200 derro of clan "Urth" and house's about 100 humanoid mercenaries(bugbears, gnolls, hob-goblins). Also an exiled family of Duergar have set up residence within the ancient dwarven hold and are acting as hired mercenaries to the "Master". It is the duergar's sole responsibility to open the ancient dwarven treasure vault, which seem's to have eluded the "Masters" greatest efforts at opening. There are a total of 16 duergar warriors within the dwarven hold, all male and all warriors. They are led by Horgul Blackfire, a 10th level duergar warrior. Due to some curse or spell set upon the duergar, they are unable to call upon their special power to become giant-size.

PLOT:

The "Master" is actually a Gray Slaad called "Vesherill". Vesherill has been planning, for over two centuries, the conquest of the north. Even when he was a human wizard, before he was infected by the bite of a blue slaad, Vesherill wished to be lord of the north. At the time, Silvermoon was a fledging city with many of the intrigues and deception that most cities boasted. Vesherill had planned to use magic and deception to take over the mantle as ruler of Silvermoon and eventually rule the north as "overking". Unfortunately for him, a demonic summons went awry and he was captured by the very slaad he was summoning. However the blue slaad did not kill him, but instead took him back with him to one of the hell's where he was infected and made to serve for a number of years. Only recently, within the last six months, was he able to gate himself back to the prime material plane and begin again his morbid fascination with conquering the north. Vesherill is a gray slaad of awesome power, 18th level wizard, who normally prefers to work alone. However, due to his imprisonment for so long, he has no allies to call upon and therefore has been using whatever creatures he has come across thru manipulation or threat of harm. Vesherill has been able to gather a small army of humanoids, but does not like his choices. He tolerates the mind flayer, "Igrik'ilthul", solely because he can make the mind flayer due the mundane commanding that he can't stand to do. Vesherill also tolerates Horgul and his band, simply because he cannot figure out how to open the Thundershield clan's treasure vault and believe's that Horgul and his men, because they are

dwarves, will be able to figure it out. Vesherrill believes that with whatever items of treasure or magic are left in the vault, he will be able to hire or summon more allies that are more "refined", i.e. demons, slaad, outsiders, etc.

Vesherrill has set up his living quarters in what use to be the dwarven temple room. Vesherrill has gained much pleasure and satisfaction by desecrating the room and other parts of the city. To insure that no other faction or creature interfere's with his plans, he has had his minions seal off the rest of the city's level's leaving only the first and second level's open. What he doesn't need right now is a clan of duergar or drow to discover his plans' of conquest and interfere at a critical time.

Vesherrill's servants:

1) "Igrik'ilthul", mind flayer, 52 hp, ac17, 10th level sorcerer, Magic- Deep Red Ion Stone, two potions of healing, Necklace of adaptation(skull shaped), two black stones of fireball(6d6 each), scroll of 4 5th level arcane spells.

2) "Horgul Blackfire", Duergar male, 86 hp, ac 26, 10th level warrior, Magic- +3 battle axe, +1 black plate armor, +1 shield, 1 potion of poison, 1 potion of firebreath.

3) Duergar warriors (16), Duergar males, levels 7 3rd , 4 5th, 2 6th, 2 7th, 1 8th, Magic- misc. +1 weapons and armor, 10 misc. potions, 2 misc magic items.

4) Derro Warriors (200), levels 1st- 5th, Magic- misc. +1 weapons and poison weapons, community treasure kept in Savant Xepel's room.

5) "Xepel", Derro Savant, 7th level, 34 hp, ac 19, Magic-Slippers of spider climbing, Candle of Invocation(chaotic evil), Assassin's Dagger +2, Scroll of 4 3rd level divine spells.

6) Evil humanoids (300), misc types, i.e. orcs, gnolls, bugbears, hobgoblins, etc.